TRT 01

Testosterone

Main male sex hormone, a steroid made in the testes; cypionate is a longer-acting ester given into muscle



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Hormone (steroid)	Low testosterone, heart safety	Large trials; FDA approved	FDA approved (Depo-Testosterone, AndroGel)

STUDIED FOR

Low testosterone	Sexual function	Heart safety
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

Fractures	Sperm production
HUMAN	HUMAN

Approved for a medical cause only. Labels say use for low testosterone due to age alone is not established. TRAVERSE tested heart safety, not symptom relief.

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- FDA approved since 1953 (first US approval)
- TRAVERSE: 5,246 men, heart events 7.0% vs 7.3%
- T Trials: 790 men aged 65 or older, 1 year

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Use for age-related low T
- Use in males under 18
- Use for athletic performance

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Testosterone ▶ DHT in tissues ▶ Androgen receptor ▶ Male traits

- **Label:** drives growth of the male sex organs and keeps up male traits
- **In many tissues** it acts after conversion to DHT, which binds receptors in cells
- **Feedback:** lowers LH; at large doses also FSH, which can suppress sperm
- **Androgens** have been reported to raise red blood cell production

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
About 8 days (cypionate injection into muscle, label)	Injection, gel, nasal gel, buccal, patch, oral (labels)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Inactivated mainly in the liver; about 90% excreted in urine	Prescription (Schedule III); compounded creams not approved
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Hemoglobin and hematocrit, blood pressure	Prohibited, class S1

REGULATORY	FDA	DEA	WADA
	Approved for hypogonadism; 2025 label update	Schedule III anabolic steroid	Prohibited at all times (S1)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Depo-Testosterone prescribing information, Aug 2026
2. FDA, class-wide labeling changes for testosterone products, Feb 2025
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

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